

I really wish I were snuggling with you right now, but I am still alone in my bed, daydreaming about the life we can have together in the future. I am so sad 😞😭❤️'

I will give a life update before getting to what I really want to get across to you in this diary.

The Philly's entry-level IT job market has been really dead this week. It happened right after I said I really want to find a job in Philly so I can afford to live with you. I think this world hates me with a burning passion 😞

Everybody at the Starbucks I work at hates our job. During one of my shifts this week, I was in the back office when one of the shift leads was talking to another shift lead before leaving. He was like, "I should tell [the other two baristas] to do something before I leave, but I don't really care. I don't like this place anyway," and then everyone started laughing because of the shared animosity toward this job.

My dog is aging rapidly. It seems like her health is getting worse every week. She did not even eat her dinner tonight. My dad said she will probably not make it through this year.

Honestly, I don't know how I will react if my dog passes away. My reactions to people I know passing away have been really weird so far. It all started when the first person I knew passed away: my grandpa, who passed away in January 2023 due to COVID. I had a video call with my grandpa a week before he died, and he was already extremely ill and weak. He could only see me and could not utter a complete sentence. I didn't know what to say during the call. Between my grandpa's health and the Title IX that was still actively going on, I didn't know what to say. I didn't even know what to feel. All I managed to say was a simple hello. How little did I know that was the last time I would ever see my grandpa.

I don't want you to misunderstand. It is not your fault that this happened. You could never have known my grandpa would pass away at that time. If there is anyone to blame, it is the Chinese government. Despite all the propaganda, China arguably handled COVID much worse than both the Trump and Biden administrations, and it grossed me out that intellectuals in the Western world are still falling for the false narrative. This week, I encountered an article written by Professor Jeffrey D. Sachs. In this article, Professor Sachs said, "The incompetence of the Trump Administration on technical issues is breathtaking. Across 25 cabinet-rank posts of the United States government, not a single one holds a PhD in any field and exactly one holds a STEM degree—at the bachelor's level. Twelve hold law degrees. Both in China and Russia, the cabinets are each filled with PhDs (any field) and officials in the sciences and engineering (more than 10 PhD and 10 STEM graduates in each cabinet)." It is true that the Trump cabinet has been extremely incompetent so far, with Bessent and Rubio as the only two people who can somewhat clean up the mess, but it is also clear that both of them will perform much better under a better boss without the fear of political repercussions. However, Professor Sachs has also fallen for the age-old false narrative that because the leadership holds PhD, the country will be more professionally led. I won't go into the details here, but if you ask any Chinese person who is not a die-hard CCP loyalist, they will all tell you that Westerners continuing to fall for this false narrative gives them migraine.

Now I'll get to the main topic of this diary entry. I will try to word and frame what I say here very carefully, since I have the impression that you are still not fully emotionally equipped to handle a hard but necessary conversation in an intimate relationship. I am not questioning your abilities. You have clearly demonstrated that you are very capable in a professional setting. However, as you have probably also noticed, how well you can handle yourself in a professional setting does not necessarily reflect how well you can do it in a romantic one. I am also not claiming to be

more emotionally mature than you. I believe the contrary is true. It is simply because my dad has hurled all kinds of insults at me while I was growing up, so my take is basically “hey, how much worse can it get?”

Anni, I really need you to talk to me before the end of this year. I don’t know how much longer I can drag myself along without your support.

I want to say a lot of things, but I don’t know if you can handle it. I also don’t know if it is the right time to say them. What I will say is based on very limited information I have; a lot of the data points seem to contradict each other. Whenever that happens, I will use pretty much the only data point I can gather from you, which is that you are not willing to talk directly to me, to override those contradictory data points. Because ultimately, you are the person I want to marry. I don’t want to give the impression that I don’t like your relatives or the people you told about us. It is just that the information I can get is very limited, and I have to give the data point that you are not willing to talk to me the highest priority.

I wanted to rant, I wanted to plead, and I even wanted to beg. I’ve been playing “I wanna be yours” because this song is exactly how I feel. However, I realized I have done all of them multiple times already.

Hope is a very interesting thing. I am not kidding when I say you are my everything. You are my hope, the flickering light that kept me going. It was the prospect of one day being together with you that made me put myself together to go through the WGU B.S. program in six months. It was the daydreaming about my future life with you that pulled me up from the sorrow of losing the full-time offer from the team I interned with at Lockheed Martin to start job hunting again, and it ultimately landed me another offer from Lockheed Martin and an offer from the NSA. It

was the hope that I would be able to utilize an experience working at the NSA to find another job in Philly to be with you one day powered me through the daunting security interview and polygraph in Maryland. Now, my second offer from Lockheed Martin and the one offer from the NSA are gone.

I really need you, Anni, now more than ever, to be by my side going through it.

I love you.